

```
ypersetup colorlinks=true, linkcolor=blue!40!black, urlcolor=blue!60!black
wcommand[1]1 wcommand[1]1 wcommand[1]1 wcommand[1]1 wcommand[1]1
```

2em

The City of Forgetting

Large A Siege Adventure for Fate's Edge

2em

*"Some cities are built on stone.
Heugen is built on the things people would kill to forget."*

Contents

1	Introduction	3
2	Heugen at a Glance	4
3	Major Factions	5
4	Adventure Structure	6
5	Act I: The Approach	6
6	Act II: Under Siege	7
7	Act III: The Wells Below	10
8	Act IV: Revelation and Reckoning	13
8.1	Bestiary	16
9	Emissary Clash Encounter Tables	19
9.1	General Doctrine Flashpoints (1d6)	19
9.2	AvehSided Challenges (1d6)	20
9.3	MykkielSided Challenges (1d6)	20
9.4	Third Path Complications (1d6)	20
9.5	Doctrine Escalation Indicator	20
10	Talents and Rites of Mykkiel and Aveh	20
11	DualFaith Conversion Mechanics	21
11.1	The Devotion Spectrum	21
11.2	Faith Conflict Scenes	21

11.3 DualOath Resolution	21
11.4 Synthesis Tokens	22
11.5 Faith Venue Tags	22
11.6 Patron Ambassadors	22
11.7 Ritual Contamination	22
11.8 GM Guidance	23
11.9 Rites of Mykkiel, Angel of Law and Form	23
11.10 Talents of Mykkiel	24
11.11 Rites of Aveh, Keeper of Unburdening and Estranged Ways	24
11.12 Talents of Aveh	24
12 Conversion Rites (Opposed Faiths)	24

wpage

1 Introduction

labelsec:intro

Premise

The city of ¶laceHeugen stands where the Paladian River meets the deserts of Galanina a bustling port of exiles, runaways, and those who have bargained away their shame.

Two centuries ago, Temple of Light crusaders founded a fortified camp here, sworn to bring “radiant order” to the desert tribes. They failed catastrophically: their campaign collapsed into scandal, atrocity, and defeat. Their martyrs were denied, their narrative broken.

In the ruins of their faith, something answered.

They turned to Aveh, the Veiled Patron of Release, who promised them life without the weight of their past. The camp became a haven for the disgraced. Wells were blessed, lotusfields planted, and rites woven to *soften* memory and *unhook* old vows.

Now ¶laceHeugen is a thriving portcity of:

tem exiled nobles and disowned heirs, tem deserters and oathbreakers, tem victims fleeing their abusers, tem witches and hedgepriests seeking peace.

Its *lotustinctured wells* and *forgetting rites* give it its nickname:

The City of Forgetting.

To followers of Mykkiel, Angel of Law, this is an abomination: a wound in the fabric of justice where crimes go unpunished, oaths lie fallow, and names are deliberately blurred.

An army marches under Mykkiel’s chainedhalo banners. Their goal is simple: *erase Heugen from the desert and restore memory to its fugitives.*

Can the adventurers save a city built on forgetting? Should they?

Adventure Tier and Scope

This adventure is tuned for:

tem **Tier:** IIIIV characters (experienced to veteran) tem **Tone:** Moral drama, siege horror, political intrigue, memory magic tem **Structure:** 46 sessions (or more, if expanded)

It can be used as:

tem a standalone minicampaign centered on the siege of ¶laceHeugen, or tem a major arc in a longer Fate's Edge campaign.

Themes and Safety

This adventure touches on themes of:

tem shame, trauma, and the desire to forget; tem justice vs. mercy; tem institutional abuse and religious zealotry; tem memory manipulation and loss of self.

Use safety tools appropriate for your group:

tem Lines and Veils (what is offlimits vs. fadedtoblack), tem XCard or Script Change, tem open table checkins during intense scenes.

PlayerFacing Summary

Hook: An army of fanatical lawbringers marches to erase the City of Forgetting, where lotusblesseds wells and secret rites let people leave their past behind. You must choose: defend the city, expose its buried truths, bargain between gods or burn it all down.

Core Questions:

tem Is forgetting mercy, cowardice, or both? tem Who deserves a second life? tem What happens if memory itself becomes a battlefield?

2 Heugen at a Glance

labelsec:heugen

City Identity

¶laceHeugen is:

tem a **riverport** on the Paladian, wedged between dunes and marsh; tem a **trade hub** for salt, glass, lotusink, and contraband; tem a **refuge citystate** ruled by a Council of Masks (names optional); tem a **ritual engine** built atop wells that *store* memory instead of erasing it.

Lotus motifs are everywhere:

tem stylised lotus sigils on doors (“I do not ask your past”), tem lotus petals in wine and tea, tem lotus pattern tilework in bathhouses and shrines, tem lotusink used for anonymous contracts.

District Sketches

Use these briefly sketched districts as flexible locations for scenes and encounters.

Lotus Wells Quarter

tem Narrow lanes, shaded balconies, public wells watched by lotuswardens. tem People come at dusk for “forgetting draughts” and confessionlike rites. tem **Hook:** Fights often break out when someone *refuses* to drink.

Riverfront and Docks

tem Flatbottom barges, desert skiffs, and foreign galleys. tem Smugglers, runaway crews, desert tribesfolk, cloaked pilgrims. tem **Hook:** First place Mykkiel’s vanguard blockades with river-chains.

Mask Market

tem Stalls selling masks, veils, false papers, and crafted new identities. tem Artisans who weave “lotusnames” public aliases bound to a charm. tem **Hook:** A PC may already have a lotusname they forgot taking.

The CisternDepths

tem Flooded tunnels under the city where old water and older memories pool. tem Rumors of whispering echoes that call out your *true name*. tem **Hook:** The heart of the final choice: keep the memories buried or release them.

3 Major Factions

labelsec:factions

Mykkiel’s Host (SIEGE • LAW)

An army of auditors, paladins, and penitents under Mykkiel’s chainedhalo icon.

tem **Goal:** Destroy Heugen, restore memories to its people, purge “stolen law.” tem **Methods:** Siege, ritual audits, public “naming trials” where forgotten deeds are read aloud. tem **Face:** PrelateSeneschal Radan, who genuinely believes he is saving souls by forcing them to remember.

The Lotus Council (CITY • AMNESTY)

Heugen’s shifting government: masked elders, exiled generals, and lotuspriestesses.

tem **Goal:** Preserve the city’s function as a refuge and its pact with Aveh. tem **Tension:** Some want open war; others prefer bargaining or evacuation. tem **Face:** SpeakerofPetals, a veiled leader whose identity may tie closely to a PC.

Aveh, the Veiled Patron (MERCY • OBLIVION)

A subtle, quiet patron whose miracles always *cost* something.

tem **Goal:** Protect those who cannot bear their past, blur the sharp edges of memory. tem **Secret:** The memories are not destroyed; they are stored in the cisterns beneath Heugen. tem **Manifestation:** Lotus petals falling in still rooms, the taste of riverwater like halfremembered lullabies, dreams where your younger self negotiates with a shadow.

Optional: Local Witchcraft Circles (COMMUNITY • THRESHOLD)

Neighborhood circles of thresholdwitches (see Threshold magic section if using that module):

tem maintain warded doorways and streetcorners; tem shelter victims of both Temple and Mykkiel abuses; tem can become powerful allies or targets during the siege.

4 Adventure Structure

labelsec:structure

Run this adventure in four broad acts. Each act can hold one or more sessions.

tem **Act I: The Approach** Arrival in Heugen as Mykkiel's host closes in. tem **Act II: Under Siege** Streetlevel missions, hard choices, and lotus bargains. tem **Act III: The Wells Below** Descent into the cisterndepths and memory vaults. tem **Act IV: Judgment of Heugen** A ritual, a siege climax, and the fate of memory itself.

Light Mechanic: Memory Pressure

Track a simple **Memory Pressure** [4] timer for the group.

Mark a segment when:

tem the PCs exploit the city's forgetting for easy gain; tem they use lotusdraughts to dodge emotional consequences; tem they bargain away someone else's memories; tem they openly side with total erasure or total exposure.

When it fills, introduce a major twist:

tem a PC's forgotten past resurfaces at the worst time; tem Aveh demands a collective price; tem Mykkiel's host gains a tactical advantage through revealed secrets.

5 Act I: The Approach

labelsec:act1

Goals

tem Introduce Heugen, its lotus culture, and its contradictions. tem Present Mykkiel's Host as a looming but notyetinevitable threat. tem Tie at least one PC personally to the city's past or its wells.

Opening Hooks

Choose one or mix several:

tem **Lotus Contract:** The PCs are hired by the Lotus Council to act as outside negotiators or troubleshooters plausible deniability when dealing with Mykkiel's emissaries. tem **Pursued Exile:** One PC (with consent) is secretly from Heugen, having once drunk from the wells. Mykkiel's vanguard has their *true name* on a writ. tem **Lost Pilgrims:** The PCs escort refugees toward Heugen as rumors of the oncoming crusade spread along the river.

Key Scenes

1. The Lotus Gate Arrival at Heugen’s rivergate:

tem guards wear lotus sigils and mirrored veils; tem new arrivals may choose to *drink* or not;
tem a tense moment when an old enemy of a PC fails to recognise them.

Choices:

tem Drinking gains shortterm social safety (fewer questions) but risks memory complications later.
tem Refusing marks PCs as “anchored” useful allies, but suspect to some locals.

2. Rumors of Chains In taverns, bathhouses, and markets:

tem talk of an army marching under chainedhalo banners; tem former Temple of Light veterans grow quiet or leave the room; tem a lotuspriestess asks the PCs what *they* would do if their worst deed were read aloud in public.

3. The First Writ Mykkiel’s Host sends a small delegation under a white flag:

tem they deliver a **Writ of Abrogation**: Heugen is to be vacated, its wells sealed, its records surrendered; tem they publicly read one anonymous but horrifying past act tied to someone in the crowd proving their power; tem the PCs can intervene to protect, expose, or bargain.

Escalation Trigger

End Act I when:

tem the Lotus Council formally asks: “*Will you help defend Heugen, or help us evacuate/appease Mykkiel’s host?*” tem or when the PCs commit to a strong stance (defense, compromise, or betrayal).

wpage

6 Act II: Under Siege

labelsec:act2

Act Tone and Function

Act II shifts from rumor and positioning to **immediacy and consequence**.

Mykkiel’s Host begins siege operations:

tem river blockades tighten, tem outlying wells collapse under holy bombardment, tem masked elders debate surrender behind closed doors, tem exiles panic as old identities begin resurfacing.

The PCs navigate moral territory:

tem Do we defend the city that hides sins? tem Is forgetting a mercy or a refusal to heal? tem Should some memories be restored?

This act is about **choosing sides while discovering what those sides really are**.

Key Siege Timers

Introduce these as the scaffolding of Act II:

tem Siege Line [6] when full, the Host breaches the riverfront. tem Council Schism [4] when full, the Lotus Council fractures, spawning rival factions. tem Memory Surge [6] when full, forgotten pasts erupt everywhere.

PC actions can fill or reduce these.

Siege Pressure Effects

Whenever a timer ticks up:

tem increase ambient tension, tem show patrols, barricades, ration lines, and waterrites at the wells, tem reveal small tragedies families drinking to forget, or refusing and breaking.

Major Scenes and Missions

Pick 24 for your group.

1. The First Breach Attempt

Mykkiel's siege engineers deploy *halochains* across the river.

tem PCs respond to a call for aid by lotuswardens. tem A ritual duel of Naming vs. Forgetting plays out on bridges. tem PCs can:tem sabotage chains, tem parley with zealots, tem or sacrifice a well's power for temporary reprieve.

2. Masks Fall from Faces

Someone important to the PCs is *recognized* by a former foe or victim.

tem Optional twist: the PC does not remember who this person is. tem PCs can mediate, deny, or demand a lotus working. tem This is where personal stakes crystallize.

3. Council of Masks Fractures

The Lotus Council calls the PCs into its chamber.

tem one faction favors **surrender**, tem one advocates **total erasure** (collapse the cisterndepths), tem one proposes **sanctioned remembrance**: return pasts – selectively.

PCs may tip the scales.

GM Prompt: Cost of Influence

Any PCrecommended course becomes a public expectation:

tem Success? They are praised as saviors. tem Failure? They are blamed as traitors or fools.

4. The Lotus Refineries Burn

Mykkiel's Host uses sanctified fire to destroy the lotusdrying towers.

tem Players must save workers, tem or protect lotus knowledge, tem or steal firesecrets from the attackers.

This is a setpiece battle with lotus petals burning in violet haze.

5. The Memory Plague Emerges

As siege pressure rises, memory instability hits Heugen:

tem Crowds forget children, tem lovers forget grievances, tem zealots suddenly remember atrocities and crack.

The PCs must stabilize outbreaks with:

tem lotus rites, tem thresholdmagic, tem or brutal Mykkiel audits *if they ally with the Host*.

Act II NPC Gallery

Use these living chess pieces:

SpeakerofPetals Veiled negotiator for the Lotus Council; pragmatic, haunted, might be tied to a PC's forgotten past.

Marshal Cruciant Siege tactician of Mykkiel's Host. Secretly doubts his cause but fears consequence.

The Aster Keeper A witch who runs the lotus wells. Protective, motherly, and terrifying when the water is threatened.

An Unnamed Child Shows up repeatedly, follows the PCs, calls one of them "*mother*" or "*father*". GM decides truth later.

Faction Shifts

Let faction alignment evolve:

tem **PCs aid the city:** Mykkiel's Host escalates earlier. tem **PCs strike a bargain:** Lotus Council schism advances. tem **PCs betray a well:** Aveh withdraws, manifest wrath, or offers new pacts.

Act II Mechanical Twist: Lotus Tokens

Introduce **Lotus Tokens**:

tem PCs earn 1 token when they defend someone's right to forget. tem PCs earn 1 token when they uncover painful hidden truth.

At 3 tokens, each PC receives a onetime benefit:

tem Lotus Mercy: Remove a consequence *or* tem Lotus Revelation: regain/restore a forgotten bond.

But each token spent fills Memory Pressure. Lotus power always has a cost.

Transition to Act III: The Wells Below

Trigger Act III when:

tem the PCs demand to know what lies beneath Heugen; or tem the lotus wells become unstable; or tem Mykkiel's Host breaches the outer wall.

A lotuspriestess (or Aveh itself) says:

"To save a city of forgetting, you must remember what lies beneath it."

Lead the party into:

tem the cisterndepths, tem vaults of stored memory, tem lotusroot catacombs, tem and perhaps the city's buried origin.

wpage

7 Act III: The Wells Below

labelsec:act3

Act Tone and Function

Act III shifts the siege narrative inward.

The city's surface burns, starves, and fractures but beneath Heugen lies the **cisternlabyrinth** where Aveh's blessing first took root.

This act is:

tem **fantastic archaeology**, tem **metaphysical infiltration**, tem and **personal crisis**.

The PCs descend past lotus wells, aqueductveins, and memorygalleries into *the buried truth of Heugen*.

Environment: The Lotus Catacombs

The cisterns are not silent.

Features:

tem Black, still water canals reflecting unreal versions of the PCs. tem Wall carvings showing pilgrims drinking the water and erasing names. tem Petalfalls drifting like snow, forming echoes of forgotten events. tem Lotus roots like ivory ribs arching overhead and underfoot.

Travel Dynamics: Treat the descent as a hazardous exploration:

tem Root Collapse [4] instability increases with noise or violence. tem Memory Echo [4] hallucinations tempt PCs to alter their past.

Key Scenes and Revelations

Choose or remix these for pacing:

1. The Flooded Gallery Murals depict the founding crusaders kneeling not before light but before a lotusrobed figure offering water.

tem Perception / Lore tests reveal Aveh was once human. tem PCs may glimpse their own pasts in the water (GM selects).

2. The Vault of Unwritten Sins A spiral chamber of suspended clay masks.

tem Each mask corresponds to a forgotten wrong. tem Touching one summons the event for judgement:tem resolve it peacefully, tem or accept a Mark of Memory (Condition), tem or shatter it evolving the *Memory Surge*.

3. The Sacarium of Names An underground tribunal where lotuspriestesses once weighed guilt.

tem PCs learn the **Lotus Sacrament of Consent**: no one was forced to forget they *asked* to. tem Reveal that some fled justice by choosing erasure.

This is the moral hinge of the campaign.

4. Aveh's Chrysalis Chamber A chrysalis of lotus fibre and ossified bone.

tem Aveh's presence speaks in divided voices: "*I gave them mercy; they called it escape.*" tem PCs confront that *forgetting is not healing*.

Aveh may offer:

tem boon, tem bargain, tem indictment, tem or unsettling truth.

The Wells of Heugen: Memory Economy

dexHeugen!Wells dexMemory Economy dexForgetting Mechanics

Drinking the Waters removes burdens at a price.

Memory Tokens

Every PC begins with:

tem **Contacts** (13 people they matter to) tem **Histories** (coping scars, debts, vows) tem **Identity Pillars** (titles, roles, reputations)

Treat these as *Memory Tokens*.

They may be **spent** during a scene to:

tem Gain **Position** +1 for a roll tem Reduce a DV by 1 tem Convert a Miss into a Partial tem Add +2d to a plea, duel, or rite

But: When you spend one, it is **erased from the character** until restored by story or ritual.

City Cap and Power Scaling

The **City Cap** (Heugen's Fate) scales the benefit:

tem[Cap 1:] +1d or DV1 only. tem[Cap 2:] as above plus heal a Condition. tem[Cap 3:] spend 1 Token to **cancel a scene timer tick**. tem[Cap 4+] spend 1 Token to **rewrite fictional positioning**: create an exit, expose a lie, force a truce.

When the crusade escalates, Cap increases. PCs can accelerate this at terrible prices.

When Tokens Run Out

If a PC reaches zero Tokens: *They become a Child of the Wells*.

tem Contacts forget them. tem Background and reputation dissolve. tem They can no longer use Aveh rites that require identity.

To reverse this, they must:

tem publicly name what was forgotten, and tem be recognized by another as true.

Encounters and Adversaries

Lotus Husk Guardians Forgotten sentients whose identities dissolved.

tem Attack with lotuslaced touch that forces Memory Echo tests. tem Can be calmed by naming rituals or Lotus Tokens.

Unremembered Priests They offer rites with unknown cost, unable to recall their own vows.

tem Bargain for safe passage, tem reveal lore, tem or collapse into hostile guiltspirals.

Siege Intrusion Mykkiel's zealots breach into the cisterns.

tem PCs may face exorcists who seek to *purify the wells*, tem triggering breach fights among rootchambers.

Act III Special Mechanic: Memory Trials

When a PC hears their name in the echoing water, they must resist revising their history.

Memory Trial

Roll *Spirit + Resolve* against DV determined by guiltweight (36).

tem[Success:] You keep your memory; gain 1 Lotus Token. tem[Partial:] You lose a detail truthfully; GM may introduce a new past tie. tem[Miss:] You forget something important; the GM marks Memory Surge.

NPC Gallery

The Quiet Mask A silent judge of the Sacrarium; offers gestures, not words.

The Aster Keeper Returned Appears here as her unforgotten self; reveals contradictions.

Aveh (Manifest / SoftSpoken) Neither god nor ghost an ideology that learned to speak.

Player Choices and Moral Forks

By the end of this act, PCs should decide:

tem **Does Heugen deserve protection?** tem **Should forgetting be defended or dismantled?** tem **Do we ally with Aveh, Mykkiel, or neither?**

Transition to Act IV: Revelation and Reckoning

Trigger Act IV when:

tem PCs commune directly with Aveh, tem or the Memory Surge reaches [6], tem or Mykkiel's Host breaches into the catacombs.

Aveh whispers:

"You cannot defend a city of forgetting without remembering what was buried."

The way opens deeper into the lotusroot vault, where the *truth origin* of Heugen sleeps.

wpage

8 Act IV: Revelation and Reckoning

labelsec:act4

Act Function

Act IV reveals that the conflict is not between gods, but between *those who claim to serve them*.

The city stands at a contested threshold:

tem Aveh's agents preach belonging without judgment, tem Mykkiel's agents demand truth without exemption, tem both insist the Patron wishes their version obeyed.

The PCs must navigate competing "mouthpieces" of power.

The RootVault of Heugen

Location and Symbolism An inverted lotus chamber beneath the dunes:

tem petals formed of salt and glass, tem memorywater flows upward in thin rivulets, tem sleeping inscriptions vibrate when truths or lies are spoken.

This is where the founders swore the covenant recorded, but never understood.

Factional Arrival

Aveh's Delegates Three rival emissaries descend:

tem The **Mask-Bearer**, who promises absolution for a price, tem The **Unbound Herald**, who insists belonging means never naming harm, tem The **Archivist of Strays**, who believes belonging demands accountability.

Each claims: *Aveh wills this.*

Mykkiel's Delegates Judicial expedition forces breach the vault:

tem The **Sword-Reader**, pronouncing sentence on the city, tem The **Law-Singer**, who insists truth must be tempered by survival, tem The **Seal-Bearer**, who would bind the city instead of destroy it.

Each claims: *Mykkiel decrees this.*

Scene Structure

Run Act IV in three escalating stages:

section*1. The Memory Tribunal

The Lotus stirs, projecting suppressed memories but no Patron speaks.

Instead:

tem emissaries cite scripture differently, tem delegates try to recruit PCs as witnesses, tem old sins of the city echo without a clear voice.

Mechanic: PCs may

textbfdeclare a personal truth to gain 1 Truth-Favor.

section*2. The Schism Court

The Root-Vault becomes a court, but no judge presides.

Play Priority: the conflict is doctrinal, not divine.

tem Aveh's factions accuse each other of betraying the Patron's mercy. tem Mykkiel's factions declare each other heretics misreading the Law. tem PCs serve as arbitrators or agitators by choice or necessity.

The vault reacts not to theology, but to:

tem stated truths, tem acknowledged harms, tem reconciled contradictions.

section*3. The Lotus Fracture

Competing doctrines destabilize the vault:

tem memory-water erupts into sandstorms, tem petals crack and bleed light, tem siege lines above buckle.

This is both literal and symbolic: **no Patron intervenes** their will is inscrutable, and their agents are the ones tearing reality.

Special Mechanic: Truth Arbitration

Truth-Favor (Campaign Currency) When a PC:

tem names a painful truth, tem bridges opposing doctrines, tem refuses to permit doctrinal violence,

they earn 1 Truth-Favor.

Truth-Favor can:

tem reduce DV of persuasion in the vault, tem countermand a doctrinal "sentence," tem prevent a Lotus collapse event.

Win Conditions of Act IV

Resolution does not come from:

tem slaying emissaries, tem summoning Patrons, tem or proving one creed "right."

Instead, the vault stabilizes when the PCs demonstrate:

tem **Synthesis:** belonging acknowledged, truth accounted for. tem **Restraint:** neither delegations nor zealots decide alone. tem **Naming Harm:** the city's past is spoken instead of swallowed.

Trigger Act V when:

tem emissaries fall silent, tem inscriptions react to the PCs instead of agents, tem and an ancient voice not a Patron, but the first founder asks:

"Whose will shall we live by yours, or another's?"

Doctrine Conflict Subsystem

labelsubsec:doctrineconflict dexDoctrine Conflict

Emissaries of Patrons assert competing interpretations of divine will. The PCs resolve these conflicts through narrative arbitration rather than force.

Doctrine Claims When two factions assert incompatible readings of a Patron's will, create a **Doctrine Clash** [4] timer.

tem Fill 1 tick when emissaries escalate rhetoric. tem Fill 1 tick when PCs stall, equivocate, or refuse to engage. tem Clear 1 tick when PCs articulate a reconciling truth or expose contradiction.

Clash Resolution When Doctrine Clash fills, the factions split violently:

tem riots, purges, or zealotry erupt, tem siege lines fracture, tem and the Lotus Vault destabilizes.

When Doctrine Clash empties through reconciliation:

tem emissaries fall silent, tem a third path becomes available, tem and the vault reacts to PCs as arbiters rather than witnesses.

PC Leverage: TruthFavor When PCs:

tem name painful truths, tem spotlight hypocrisy, tem or invoke shared stakes,
award 1 **TruthFavor**. Spend 1 TruthFavor to:

tem clear 1 tick on Doctrine Clash, tem or suppress zealot escalation for a scene.

This subsystem rewards narrative mediation while making doctrine tension tangible without requiring divine intervention.

8.1 Bestiary

[The WellsWorm Shame Devourer] • • •

Sand bulges like lungs; whispering voices underfoot; lotus petals desiccate.

It never speaks first. If someone confesses truth, it recoils. If someone lies, the sand stirs.

section*Profile

tem **Tier:** IV tem **Scale:** Huge (city threat) tem **Presence:** Oppressive, horizonspanning
tem **Position:** Starts Dominant tem **Resonance:** Gains strength from forgotten things

section*Boss Moves

tem **Consume Memory:** Force a PC to lose a Memory Token and heal a Phase. tem **Sand Maw Drag:** Pull a PC underground into a hallucinated past. tem **False Relief:** Offer to take away a burdenmark Corruption if accepted. tem **Echoed Guilt:** Speak in the voice of someone the PC failed. tem **Burrowing Surge:** Erupt under a group, scattering them across zones.

section*SB Menu (GM Spending)

tem Target loses 1 Memory Token (unnamed). tem The Worm becomes Hidden until provoked. tem A PC hears a forgotten voicemark *Shadowed*. tem Crowd or NPCs panic and flee or betray. tem A crusader claims "This proves the city must burn."

Phases of the WellsWorm

The creature cannot be slain only *forced to disgorge what it has eaten*.

It manifests in three escalating forms:

Phase I: The Burrowed Serpent

tem **Attack:** Sand Lash (Fatigue 2 + displacement) tem **Trigger:** PCs reveal vulnerability → The Worm surfaces tem **Vulnerability:** Public naming of personal truths lowers its Position

Phase II: The Mirror of Shame

tem **Attack:** Manifest someone forgotten, forcing confession tem **Trigger:** First Phase defeated or someone Confesses tem **Special:** PCs must speak truth or lose 1 Memory Token tem **Vulnerability:** Collective witness (three or more PCs acknowledge truth)

Phase III: The Voice of Forgetting

tem **Attack:** The Offer "Let it go, and walk free." PCs may:tem[*Accept:*] Heal a Condition but lose 2 Tokens. tem[*Refuse:*] Take Fatigue +1 and become *Shadowed*.

tem **Trigger:** First two shells unraveled tem **Vulnerability:** PCs must confess an unspoken truth and be witnessed.

Confrontation Negotiation

Negotiation is possible at grave risk.

tem **DV:** 5 (Desperate) tem **Stake:** On Miss, the Worm eats the negotiator's *Identity Pillar* tem **Reward:** The Worm releases 1 eaten soul or memory into play

Weaknesses

tem **Confession.** tem **Collective witness.** tem **Namespeaking:** When three truths are named aloud, reduce its Scale.

Defeat Conditions

The Worm cannot be slain but it can be driven back if:

tem at least one truth is confessed publicly, tem three witnesses acknowledge it, and tem someone refuses its Offer at cost.

If all are met, it *vomits up* a reliquary: a lotus kernel containing memory, soul, or city secret.

Escalation: The City Under Judgment

Each time the WellsWorm is confronted:

tem Raise the City's **Cap** by 1 tem Shift one district toward:tem[*Forgetfulness*] identity dissolves, or tem[*Remembrance*] painful truth surfaces

tem Crusade Timers advance: "Proof of Sin" or "Purging Justified"

Crusader Propaganda: The WellsWorm as Proof of Sin

dexPropaganda!Crusader dexCrusade!Moral Justification

The adherents of Mykkiel do not see the WellsWorm as a horror to understandthey see it as **confirmation**.

To them, it is the *inevitable consequence* of a city built on hidden shame: a desertborn parasite that thrives on unconfessed truths.

Their commanders call it:

"A scourge fed by secrecy, and thus proof the people are unworthy to rule themselves."

Messaging Themes Crusader preachers and heralds twist sightings into a narrative:

tem **The Worm is Aveh's Shadow:** evidence that the city's pact is corrupt. tem **It Feeds on Forgetting:** therefore its existence reveals a population too weak to remember righteousness. tem **Only Purification Ends It:** siege, confession, subjugationor flame.

Mechanics: Siege of Narrative Treat propaganda as a Weapon:

tem[Effect:] Each time the Worm surfaces publicly, the *Crusader Moral Timer* ticks +1.
tem[If full:] The Crusaders' resolve becomes unbreakable; parley DV +2 until the city performs a public Rite of Contrition.

Scene Effects When crusader agents spread this rhetoric:

tem **Civilians fracture:** some demand absolution, some denial. tem **City Guard morale wavers.** tem **Priests of Aveh grow divided:** is the Worm a test or a curse?

Rumor Engine Whenever the Worm acts or is glimpsed, roll 1d6:

- 1 "The Worm speaksthe city hides something."
- 2 "Aveh cannot protect us; Mykkiel saw this coming."
- 3 "The Worm appeared at the wellit smells our guilt."
- 4 "The crusaders warned us; now they must save us."
- 5 "The walls are lies, the Worm is the truth."
- 6 "Only submission will end this horror."

Each rumor advances one timer:

tem **Crisis of Faith** [4] tem **Crusader Legitimacy** [6]

Counterplay: Truth as Rebuttal PCs or Aveh's agents reduce these Timers by:

tem **Public Witness to truth** tem **Naming wounds and sins openly** tem **Leading communal rites of remembrance**

These reduce either Timer by 12, depending on crowd size and sincerity.

Design Note for GMs Do not overwrite player success with propaganda *use it as tension*. Every sighting of the WellsWorm increases pressure to either:

tem **cleanse** the city, or tem **change** it

Both paths are victory conditions but with radically different endings.

[MaskBearer of Aveh] • • Veiled face; lacquered mask; voice soothing but hollow. Offer absolution without cost; erase confessed memory; inflame denial of harm. MaskPardon (ignore a Sin timer tick), Forgetting Rite (one shame erased), Sanctuary Under Mask (1 scene). Unmasked truths; survivors whose harm persists; any demand for accountability. [Archivist of Strays] • • Featherless quill; scrolls that bleed ink; calm counting tone. Name unpaid harms; price restitution; stabilize conflict through witnessing. Record of Reckoning (DV 1 to mediation), Ledger of Mercy (reduce Harm by 1 if debt named), Witness Seal (1 scene truce). Silence; lies; crowds demanding clean absolution. [Unbound Herald] • • Open palms; too smooth voice; always interrupts accountability. Deflect blame; collapse nuance; turn reconciliation into accusation of division. Sweetness of Silence (DV 1 to ignore conflict), "We Are One" Mantle (Position +1 vs truthsayers). Named specifics; harmed voices; receipts of consequence.

section Mykkiel's Emissaries

[SwordReader of Mykkiel] • • Razor bound in scripture; no shadow; verdicts spoken as cuts. Pronounce sentence without context; escalate punishment; mark heresy timers. Sentence Seal (one person bound), Purity Look (truth forced), Blade of Measure (Position +1 to dominate parley). Ambiguity; testimony of nuance; conflicting doctrine.

[LawSinger of Mykkiel] • • Balancing tones; sand shaped runes; voice like steel smoothed. Reinterpret verdicts into mercy; grant amnesty clauses; stabilize crowds. Harmonized Mandate (reduce Suffering timer by 1), Tempered Seal (truce scene), Binding Hymn (DV 1 to reconciliation). Extremes either faction freezes them out.

[SealBearer of Mykkiel] • • Lead scrolls; waxen sigils; keys for unseen locks. Bind a region under oath; demand confession for liberation; convert conflict into custody. BondSeal (bind a district), Confession Rite (DV 1 on interrogation), Safe Custody (protect a target while holding them). Ungoverned spaces; refusals to name wrongs; impossible witnesses.

9 Emissary Clash Encounter Tables

labelsec:emissaryclash dexEncounters!Doctrine Conflicts

Emissary clashes occur when rival interpretations of Patron will collide in view of mortals. These tables generate scenes, pressure points, and thirdparty complications.

Roll 1d6, or select for thematic fit.

9.1 General Doctrine Flashpoints (1d6)

tem **The Misheard Miracle:** A small supernatural sign is witnessed; two emissaries issue contradictory readings. tem **The Surviving Victim:** A harmed voice interrupts ritual narratives, demanding accountability or mercy. tem **The Unclaimed Dead:** A body becomes locus of dispute punishment or absolution? tem **The Found Testament:** A fragment of doctrine surfaces but its ambiguity fuels escalation. tem **The Crowd Turns:** Onlookers adopt the

most dramatic interpretation, driving panic and zealotry. tem **The Public Accusation:** One emissary denounces another as heretical; the clash polarizes bystanders.

9.2 AvehSided Challenges (1d6)

dexAveh encounters

tem **Confession Without Cost:** MaskBearers offer absolution so freely it destabilizes bonds; reckoners object. tem **The Forgotten Debt:** A victim remembers harm despite absolution, triggering repudiation of false mercy. tem **Ledger Crack:** Two Aveh emissaries argue whether belonging requires consequence or forgetting. tem **Sweet Denial:** The Unbound Herald interrupts accountability, accusing truthseekers of betrayal. tem **Runaway Refugee:** A supplicant flees into Aveh's faction was it sanctuary or abduction? tem **Memory Leak:** A forgotten truth resurfaces; Avehaligned factions recoil, Mykkiel's escalate.

9.3 MykkielSided Challenges (1d6)

dexMykkiel encounters

tem **Sentence Without Context:** SwordReaders demand punitive verdicts; LawSingers struggle to temper them. tem **Confession Shaping Truth:** A SealBearer demands public testimony that distorts narrative for custody. tem **Mercy on Trial:** A LawSinger grants reprieve; zealots call it heresy. tem **Binding the Wrong One:** A SealBearer shackles an innocent; Aveh emissaries weaponize outrage. tem **Purity Riot:** Punishers whip a crowd into zealotry; PCs must redirect or disperse. tem **Doctrine Split:** Two Mykkiel factions pronounce opposed interpretations; schism timer rises.

9.4 Third Path Complications (1d6)

dexThird Path encounters

These scenes appear when PCs clear *Doctrine Clash* (§??) or assert reconciliatory truths.

tem **Reconciliation Vision:** A supernatural sign points to shared stakes emissaries hesitate. tem **The Forgotten Clause:** A doctrinal artefact surfaces showing both sides once shared a covenant. tem **The Returning Witness:** Someone harmed by both sides demands a new framework, not victory. tem **The Lotus Insight:** PCs glimpse a transcendent reading emissaries falter, crowd listens. tem **The Silent Audience:** A supernatural hush forces emissaries to hear, not speak. tem **The Ledger Tears:** A metaphysical record splits PCs can rewrite doctrine or let chaos rewrite it.

9.5 Doctrine Escalation Indicator

Whenever three emissary scenes occur without reconciliation, increase the **Doctrine Clash** timer by 1.

Whenever a Third Path scene resolves peacefully, reduce the timer by 1.

10 Talents and Rites of Mykkiel and Aveh

labelsec:patronTalentsAvehMykkiel

This section provides thematic Talents and usable Rites for two opposed but intertwined Patrons: **Mykkiel** (Law, Form, Judgement) and **Aveh** (Forgetfulness, Refuge, Unmaking of Shame). These entries reflect mortal interpretation. Patrons do not act directly. `dexPatrons!Mykkiel dexPatrons!Aveh dexRites!Mykkiel dexRites!Aveh`

11 DualFaith Conversion Mechanics

`labelsec:dualFaith dexFaith!dual dexConversion dexOaths!religious`

Some characters walk between Patrons. This subsystem enables dramatic, mechanical representation of dualfaith loyalty without complex bookkeeping.

Patrons possess *want and will but no agency*; their followers act in their names, often at crosspurposes.

11.1 The Devotion Spectrum

`dexDevotion Spectrum`

Each character may track faith tension on a single spectrum:

$$3 \text{ (Patron A extreme)} 0 \text{ (Balanced)} + 3 \text{ (Patron B extreme)}$$

Only major revelation, vow, or rite scene shifts the spectrum.

Mechanical Effects by Position

`tem[2 or lower:]` Gain Position +1 when acting in Patron A's ethos, but Position 1 when acting under Patron B's ethos. `tem[0:]` Gain +1d when mediating faith conflicts, but suffer DV +1 on either side when pressed to choose. `tem[+2 or higher:]` Gain Position +1 under Patron B's ethos, but Position 1 under Patron A's.

11.2 Faith Conflict Scenes

`dexScenes!faith conflict`

When a scene revolves around doctrinal choice, the GM places the character at Controlled, Desperate, or Dominant based on:

`tem` which Patron's ethos the action aligns with, `tem` their current spectrum position, `tem` witness pressure (emissaries, crowds, oathkeepers).

11.3 DualOath Resolution

`dexOaths!dual`

If a character simultaneously holds vows from two Patrons:

`tem` When rolling under either vow, any **1s** trigger a choice:`tem` Offend One Faith mark *Spiritual Conflict* (Condition) with that Patron; or `tem` Delay Judgment increase the Devotion Spectrum by 1 toward indecision (toward 0).

Resolving Spiritual Conflict A dramatic scene is required:

tem **Public prioritization** of one vow over another, or tem **Syncretic declaration** recognized by witnesses.

Clearing the Condition restores normal action.

11.4 Synthesis Tokens

dexTokens!synthesis

When a character successfully blends rites, customs, or mediates opposed faithful, they gain a **Synthesis Token**.

Each token may be spent to:

tem improve Position +1 on a faithbased roll, tem gain +1d on parley between opposed factions, tem establish *temporary sanctuary* in contested religious space.

Synthesis Tokens reset after significant betrayal or revelation.

11.5 Faith Venue Tags

dexTags!venue

Scenes may be marked with religious tags:

tem[ShrineFavored:] Those aligned to Patron A gain Position +1; Patron B aligned suffer Position 1. tem[TempleFavored:] Reverse of ShrineFavored. tem[Contested Ground:] Both sides Position 1 until someone bridges the divide (GM may spend 1 SB to create opportunity).

Venue tags shift only after decisive events or rites.

11.6 Patron Ambassadors

dexTalents!Ambassador

Characters who consistently bridge opposed faiths may earn:

tem[Ambassador Status:] Once per session, convert a faithbased Position penalty into a bonus.

Ambassador Status is lost if the character publicly betrays one faith.

11.7 Ritual Contamination

dexContamination

Performing a Patron's rite in unfavored ground marks a **Contamination Token**:

tem suffers 1d on faith rolls until purified, forgiven, or confessed. tem may be *converted to XP* (1 token = 1 XP toward faith talent).

11.8 GM Guidance

dexFaith!GM guidance

tem Faith tension works best when visible to NPCs. tem Place opportunity in scenes for syncretic declaration. tem Let emissaries disagree over interpretation Patrons do not act in person, only through mortal mandate.

Play

In-

tent:

These

me-

chan-

ics

frame

con-

ver-

sion

as

iden-

linewidth *tity*

con-

flict

with

con-

se-

quences,

not

a

stat-

line

op-

ti-

miza-

tion.

11.9 Rites of Mykkiel, Angel of Law and Form

Domain Themes Oaths, structure, duty, naming, binding, revelation through ordeal.

tem **Seal the Ledger** [BIND] [TRUTH] [SANCTION]

Mark a witnessed oath. Until fulfilled or renounced, both sides gain +1d when acting in alignment, and suffer +1 DV when acting against it. tem **Sword of Interpretation** [JUDGE] [CUT] [CLARIFY]

Force one truth into prominence. A contested scene must pivot around that interpretation; resisting it costs +1 Fatigue. tem **Light of Sentence** [REVEAL] [SHAME] [FORM]

Unmask one concealed intention or guilt. Targets must speak or pay 1 Harm or Condition (GM discretion). tem **Sanctified Witness** [SEAL] [ORDER] [TEST]

Create a space where actions become binding and logged. Social or magical violence carries an

added price (Condition: *Marked*). tem **Clause of Mercy** [REPRIEVE] [BALANCE] [LEDGER]
 Designate a sin forgiven but bind the forgiven to one duty that, if failed, doubles consequences. tem **SwordQuiet** [SILENCE] [COMPULSION] [LAW]
 Still a riot or argument long enough for judgment. Lasts one scene; backlash creates rivals with *Just Cause*.

11.10 Talents of Mykkiel

dexTalents!Mykkiel

tem[DoctrineBearer (4 XP):] Once per session, declare one outcome as *precedent*. Allies gain +1d when invoking your ruling; enemies do so too in appeal. tem[Witness of the Unnamed Price (6 XP Prestige):] When you mark someone guilty (fictionally), once per session you may shift one failed roll into a partial but mark 1 Fatigue for the burden of judgment. tem[Mercy as Blade (4 XP):] When you spare someone, gain Position +1 against them until they betray or defy your mercy.

11.11 Rites of Aveh, Keeper of Unburdening and Estranged Ways

Domain Themes Forgetting, refuge, belonging, shedding past harm, dissolving identity into new masks.

tem **Drift the Ledger** [FORGET] [MASK] [BREAK]

Remove one witnessed shame or debt for a scene. Afterward, roll DV 3: on Miss, it resurfaces twisted. tem **Mask Right of Sanctuary** [REFUGE] [ROLE] [COST]

Grant someone absolution from past name or crime; they take on a new mask until dawn or crisis. This creates debts the GM may invoke. tem **Lotus Sip** [FORGET] [CALM] [SUBLIME]
 Ease Harm or Fatigue in a target, but they temporarily lose an important memory or drive. tem **Unmake the Chain** [SUNDER] [ESCAPE] [UNMAP]

Break a declared consequence, bond, or pursuit. Alarmingly popular with fugitives. tem **The Sweet Lie** [VEIL] [COMFORT] [HOOK]

Offer a truth as they wish it to be. For one scene, they gain +1d when acting under the lie; at scene end, mark a complication. tem **Breath of the Nameless Feast** [ABSOLVE] [FADE] [COST]
 Consume a small shame or misdeed gain 1 Boon, but someone else experiences its consequence.

11.12 Talents of Aveh

dexTalents!Aveh

tem[MaskShift Initiate (4 XP):] Once per session, remove a social or narrative stigma from yourself or an ally it returns later in altered form. tem[Keeper of Lost Doors (6 XP Prestige):] You can declare "There was always another way out." Spend 1 Fatigue to rewrite one exit or solution into the fiction. tem[Sap of Forgetting (2 XP Minor):] When you comfort someone, you may ease their Condition but they lose a small truth or detail they valued.

12 Conversion Rites (Opposed Faiths)

labelsec:conversionRites dexRites!conversion dexFaith!conversion

Conversion between Patrons is never simple. These rites represent ritualized thresholds that mark allegiance, temptation, conflict, or synthesis between opposed faiths.

All conversion rites carry risk: they may shift the Devotion Spectrum (§??) or mark *Spiritual Conflict*.

Rite of First Leaning

[DECLARATION] [OATH]

Effect: The supplicant publicly voices doubt in their current Patron or expresses aspiration toward another. Gain:

tem +1 **Synthesis Token** if done with witness tem OR shift the Devotion Spectrum one step toward the desired Patron

Cost: Mark +1 **Exposure** to emissary scrutiny. If secrecy is kept, gain no benefit.

Rite of Renunciation

[OATH] [CONFLICT] [TRIAL]

Effect: A symbolic cutting of ties: burning a token, unmaking a vow, or shaming a past title.

Shift Devotion Spectrum by 2 toward the new faith, but mark **Spiritual Conflict** unless a witness validates the act.

Push It: If the rite is performed in unfavored ground without permission, gain +1d on the shift but mark a **Contamination Token**.

Rite of the Two Lamps (or Two Wells)

[MEDIATION] [BALANCE]

Effect: A ritual of dual affirmation: one hand to each altar, lamp, or well. Roll Spirit + Resolve to maintain balance.

tem **Success:** Gain *Ambassador Status* for this scene. tem **Partial:** Mark 1 *Synthesis Token* but suffer DV +1 vs either side. tem **Miss:** Trigger a doctrinal challenge scene immediately.

Rite of Invocation by Doubt

[TEST] [REVELATION]

Effect: The supplicant petitions a Patron through uncertainty: "I do not know; show me."

GM frames a vision or emissary encounter. Resolve a DV 45 *Insight* test.

tem **Success:** Shift devotion one step AND gain a hidden name, phrase, or rite fragment from the target Patron. tem **Partial:** Shift devotion but mark *Spiritual Conflict*. tem **Miss:** Emissaries contradict gain +2 Suspicion in the opposing faction.

Rite of Severance and Binding

[OATH] [SACRIFICE] [WITNESS] [SCAR]

Effect: A profound vow: the supplicant binds themselves to a Patron's ethos while severing their former identity.

Choose:

tem Sacrifice a Resource tem Sacrifice Harm 2 tem Sacrifice a Reputation tag

Shift devotion 23 steps and clear *Spiritual Conflict*.

Obligation: Mark an **Obligation Timer** [4]:

tem fulfill a service, tem spread doctrine, tem restore something wronged.

If unfulfilled, the spectrum swings back by 2.

Rite of Syncretic Crown (Final Rite)

[UNITY] [NARRATIVE] [JUDGMENT]

Effect: This rite may only occur once the supplicant has:

tem touched both faiths meaningfully, tem mediated a conflict scene, tem survived emissary judgment.

The supplicant declares their synthesis a principle that both Patrons *could* accept.

Mechanical Resolution:

tem Roll Spirit + Command or Spirit + Lore (DV 5+) tem Spend 13 *Synthesis Tokens*

Success:

tem Character moves to Devotion 0 (Balanced) tem Gain permanent **Ambassador Talent** (ignore first Position penalty in faith scenes per session) tem Either faith may claim them as a righteous example

Partial:

tem Balanced devotion, but mark **Spiritual Conflict** tem One faction becomes hostile or demands a price

Miss: The rite is rejected publicly shift devotion to the extreme of whichever faith dominates the scene and mark **+2 Suspicion**.

Possession Exorcism

dexPossession dexExorcism

A soul may be seized by:

tem guilt too large to bear, tem a memory denied, tem or a hungry emissary's doctrine.

Possession Procedure

When a PC or NPC breaks under pressure, mark:

tem[Shadowed:] they hear whispers of their buried truth. tem[Claimed:] they act upon it without consent. tem[Lost:] the entity speaks through them.

Exorcism as Rite or Duel

The Mykkiel Method: Purge by Confession

tem DV 4 (Desperate) tem spend 1 Memory Token (named) tem roll Spirit + Resolve tem
On Success: entity expelled but shame remains as scar

The Aveh Method: Relinquish and Rewrite

tem DV 4 (Controlled) tem PCs or target **rewrite** the memory: change "what happened" into "what it means now" tem spend 1 Contact or Pillar tem On Success: entity dissolves; target heals but forgets

Failure Effects

tem Entity becomes external (spawn "ShameWorm spawn") tem PCs gain Corruption or lose Token involuntarily tem Crusaders gain proof the city must burn

DualFaith Exorcism

If both rites are used:

tem PCs spend 2 Tokens combined tem Target is freed *and* remembers **but must now choose a patron**